The Egyptian corpus: wisdom and creation (`חכמה-ובריאה-במצרים/`)

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Round 4, run 3 (2026-10-23): the folder's **first Egyptian corpus** and its first Egyptian translations (the fifth-day
dossier of the Ugaritic corpus already had Merikare E 130–136). The plan row: `../curated-translation-candidates.md`,
"Round 4 plan", run 3; the survey: `../curation-surveys/world-survey--egypt--2026-10-21.md` (§2.1–§2.3).

The texts and why

Project	Text	Date	Why (Bible)	Why (the ancient mind)
1--מוסר-אמנמופה/	**The Instruction of Amenemope** (pBM EA 10474, complete: prologue + 30 "houses", 551 lines)	composed c. 1300–1075 BCE; the papyrus c. 650 BCE; 21st-dynasty tablets and ostraca	**Prov 22:17–24:22** (accepted dependence); the Torah's boundary stone (Deut 19:14, 27:17), balance and weights (Lev 19:35–36, Deut 25:13–16), the blind and the lame (Lev 19:14), the widow (Deut 24:19–21), bribes (Ex 23:8)	the most inward Egyptian ethics: the "silent" and the "hot" man, a land surveyor's conscience, man as clay and straw in the god's hands
2--בריאה-במצרים/	**Merikare E 130–138** (the hymn to the creator); **the Memphite Theology** (the Shabaka Stone); **Pyramid Texts 571, 486, 527, 600** ("not yet", Atum's self-creation)	Merikare composed c. 2050 BCE (ms. c. 1450); the stone c. 710 BCE (the composition debated); the Pyramid Texts c. 2350–2250 BCE	Gen 1:2, 1:21, 1:26–30, 2:7 (Merikare); Gen 1 (creation by word), 2:2–3 (Ptah "rested"); Gen 2:4b–5 ("not yet")	how Egyptians imagined the first moment: a god alone in dark water, creating by thought and word, by seed and spittle
3--ספר-הפרה-השמימית/	**The Book of the Heavenly Cow** (KV 17, Seti I; 95 columns)	the oldest copy on Tutankhamun's shrine, c. 1325 BCE	Gen 6:5–8 (the decision to destroy rebellious mankind), 8:21–22 (a remnant survives), 11 (gods and men separated)	the old, tired sun god; a goddess drunk on red beer; the aetiology of an imperfect world

Project	Text	Date	Why (Bible)	Why (the ancient mind)
4--מעשה-בשני-האחים/	**The Tale of the Two Brothers** (pD'Orbiney, 185 lines; Late Egyptian)	c. 1200 BCE (Seti II)	**Gen 39** (the seduction and the false accusation), Gen 2:22 (a wife "built" by Khnum), Gen 37, 41	brothers, a wife's lie, the heart kept on a cedar, death and rebirth as bull, tree and son
5--פפירוס-וסטקר/	**The Tales of pWestcar** (305 lines; the wax crocodile = the dossier's WC)	composed c. 1800 BCE; ms. c. 1600	**Ex 7:8–12** (חַרְטֻם), **Ex 14:21–22** (the parted lake), Gen 50:26 (110 years), Ex 1:15–21 (midwives)	magicians at court, a king amused and taught; "not on a human being, the god's noble flock"
6--ספר-המתים-125/	**The Book of the Dead, chapter 125** (pNu, 115 lines: the hall of the Two Truths, the 42 denials)	18th dynasty, c. 1400 BCE	**Ps 15, 24:3–6**, **Deut 26:13–14**, Job 31, the Decalogue, Lev 19	the judgement of the dead, the heart on the balance, a ritual of entry by names
7-סינוהה/	**The Story of Sinuhe** (R 1–23 + B 1–311 = 334 lines)	c. 1900–1800 BCE	**Deut 8:7–9** (the land of Yaa), Gen 37–50 (an Egyptian among Asiatics, burial at home), 1 Sam 17 (the duel)	exile and homesickness, the king's grace, Egypt as the only place to die
8--המלח-הנטרף/	**The Shipwrecked Sailor** (pPetersburg 1115, 191 lines)	c. 1900 BCE	Jonah 1–2, Gen 3:1 (a speaking serpent, here a god), Ps 107:23–30	consolation by a story; a lonely god who lost his kin to a falling star

Round 5 run 6 (2026-10-31) added projects 4–8, the Egyptian tales and BD 125, here rather than in a new corpus:
the same language, base, tool and renderings (`renderings.md` §11 says why). The folder's name

stays (the print stubs
point to it); read it as "the Egyptian corpus".

Reading order: Merikare (short; the dossier's lines) → the Pyramid Texts → the Memphite Theology → the Heavenly Cow →
Amenemope.

Base texts (`../sources-registry.md` §4.4t)

- **AED-TEI** (S. D. Schweitzer 2019: the TLA's January 2018 database snapshot as TEI; **CC BY-SA 4.0**, committed under
  `../sources/AED-TEI/`) for Amenemope, Merikare, the Pyramid Texts and the Heavenly Cow, with the other witnesses.
  Read through `../tools/aed2md.py`; the corpus tool is `egypt_tools.py` (`../tools.md`).
- **El Hawary 2010** (OBO 243, open access on ZORA) for the Memphite Theology (not in AED): our transcription of his
  transliteration from the page images, `../sources/El-Hawary-2010--Wortschoepfung--OBO-243/memphite-transliteration.tsv`.
- Rank 3–5 checks: the TLA's German (in AED); **Lange 1925** (Amenemope, public domain, OCR); **Hornung 1997** (the Cow,
  OBO 46, open access); El Hawary's German (the Memphite Theology).

Shared files

- `renderings.md` – the names, the transliteration convention, the grammar mapping, the key terms, the reserved words
  (`egypt_tools.py gates`), the formulas, the fixed lines, the Amenemope ↔ Proverbs table (§8).
- `translator-brief--egyptian.md` – the brief every translator gets (the ★ rules).
- `egypt_tools.py` – data / tr / fill / lex / lemma / verify / build / grep / gates / selftest.
- `parallels-index.md` – the projects' parallels, by Bible verse (`build_parallels_index.py`).

Status

See each `project.md`. Verify with `python3 -I -B egypt_tools.py verify --strict` and `selftest`.